(July 1967) he denounced Israel's "frenzy of belligerence, arrogance and fanaticism," the noxious conjuring up of "biblical myths and all the ancient religious-national symbols of Jewish history."[30] Israel was a Western anti-communist outpost in the Middle East blocking Arab national aspirations; it was a bastion of "racial-Talmudic exclusiveness and superiority."[31] Indeed, the famed biographer of Trotsky could scarcely contain his disgust at the medieval scenes of hassidim "jumping with joy at the Wailing Wall."[32] The fact that most of these pious Jews did not recognize the Israeli State was entirely secondary.

Cosmopolitan Jewish intellectuals in the West have often been scathing about Israel. For example, the literary critic, George Steiner repeatedly glorified the "wandering exile" and the rootless Jew along with the "text" as the true homeland of the People of the Book. Zionism, in establishing a Jewish nation-state armed to the teeth in the heart of the Middle East, had abandoned the sublime history of Judaism in exchange for banal "normalcy," the illusion of physical security, and the corrupting influence of power politics.[33]

Even more vitriolic are American Jewish intellectuals like Noam Chomsky, who regard the Palestinians as a bastion of "moderation" faced by a ruthless power-hungry Israel which has supposedly terrorized the entire Middle East. Israeli "apartheid" in Chomsky's warped judgment is far worse than its South African model.[34] Not surprisingly, Chomsky admired the deceased Hebrew University Professor Israel Shahak, whose vitriolic rantings often echoed the anti-Talmudic slanders contained in classical antisemitic literature. Shahak provided these libels with the "authentic" stamp of Israeli anti-Zionist scholarship, which Chomsky all-too-eagerly endorsed.[35]

Chomsky's brashest disciple, Norman G. Finkelstein, son of Holocaust survivors, long ago surpassed his master in the vituperative abuse of America and Israel. One of his favorite anti-Zionist clichés is that American Jewish leaders deliberately silence any protests against Israeli "atrocities" by constant accusations of antisemitism against the "critics" of Israel.[36]

In recent years Finkelstein became *the* Jewish icon for a motley assortment of Islamists, neo-Nazis, Holocaust deniers, fascist antisemites, and deluded leftists who believe that demonic Israel is the source of all their woes.[37] Cruder than Chomsky, Finkelstein does not see Jews as a a people at all but rather as a kind of parasitic class with no historic right whatsoever to a historic homeland in Israel, to self-defense against Palestinian terrorism, or to a Law of Return to preserve their group identity.[38] An unpleasant odor of hubris, rage, and contempt for Judaism, Jewish history, and Zionist politics oozes from such polemics.[39] Nevertheless, more recently, Finkelstein has

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